

**UROMI JUSTICE DEVELOPMENT PEACE AND CARITAS INITIATIVES
(UROMI JDCPI)**

CORPORATE FACT SHEET

Name	Uromi Justice Development Peace & Caritas Initiatives, (Uromi JDCPI).
Owner	Catholic Diocese of Uromi, Nigeria.
Legal Holder	His Lordship, Most Rev. Dr. Donatus Aimioshor Ogun (OSA)
Authorized Representative & Director	Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Oriabure Arhedo
Corporate Registration No:	CAC/IT/No: 50042 & ED/MWASD/NGOR/200/04
Status	Catholic Non-Governmental, Non-Profit making, Humanitarian and Development Organization.
Motto	Hope for the Oppressed and Empowerment for All
Areas of operation	Integral Development, Human Rights, Democracy, and Good Governance, Alternative Dispute Resolution, Prison Apostolate and Legal Aid services, Peace Building, Micro-Credit and Caritas, TB and HIV/AIDS care and support, HIV Counseling and testing, Livelihood improvement, Anti-Human trafficking and VC programming
Project steered	Conflict Management, Training of Electorate, Election Observation, Budget Monitoring, Community TB Care, HIV/AIDS Awareness Creation & Counseling, Micro-Credit Facilities, Rural Community Development Enlightenment Campaign, Prisoners' Welfare Services, Gender And Child Rights, Widowhood Association, Human Rights, Training Programmes for Police Officers and Youths, Women Development & Promotion through Micro Credit, Emergency Response, Legal Aid, VC Programming, Capacity Strengthening for Good Governance, Campaigns and Sensitizations Against Human Trafficking as well as Creating Alternatives to Human Trafficking through Vocational Skills Acquisition and Empowerment, Human Right Education and Paralegal Scheme and Don't Pay With Your Life
Focus Group	The rural populace, the economically deprived, families, children, students, youths, women and widows living among the poorest of the poor in the society. Inmates in Prison and Ex-inmates, persons stigmatized with deadly diseases.
Physical Address	Inside Uromi Diocesan Chancery at Egbele, Uromi, Edo State, Nigeria.

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Bankers	• UBA BANK PLC Mission Road, Uromi • ECOBANK PLC Mission Road, Uromi • FIDELITY BANK PLC Mission Road, Uromi • Unity Bank PLC Mission Road Uromi • Union Bank PLC Mission Road Uromi
Staff Strength	13
Number of Community Volunteers	65
Project Executed	16

INTRODUCTION

Uromi Justice Development Peace and Caritas Initiatives sustained developmental effort across its thematic areas to contribute to peaceful coexistence, better information sharing and improved livelihood in the five Local Government Areas of Edo Central Senatorial District.

Uromi JDPCI provided another round of capacity building for the Paralegals and human rights advocates in 26 communities across the five LGAs. The training was on Gender Equality and Gender Based Violence. Uromi JDPCI also facilitated quarterly meeting of paralegals to allow for experience sharing and shared learning. This was to strengthen the effort for the development of synergy and mobilization of local resources for effective response to human rights promotion in the selected communities across the five LGAs.

Uromi JDPCI also supported forty three beneficiaries in the Don't Pay With Your Life project with One Hundred Thousand Naira each to set up Income Generating Activities. Monitoring visits were also conducted to beneficiaries in previous project while both beneficiaries were engaged in discussion on Children's personality with a bid to improve their capacity for improved caregiving which would reduce susceptibility to human trafficking and irregular migration. Uromi JDPCI further engaged in monitoring visit to beneficiaries of the SMAT-P project with a view to determine achievements of the project which was implemented to curb the ugly trend of human trafficking and irregular migration in Edo Central Senatorial District.

The Micro Credit desk also sustained the empowerment drive with the provision of support to beneficiaries in groups across communities in Edo Central Senatorial District. There is great improvement in the assessment of loan through bank transfer. Although the refund of loan is still manual

QUARTERLY MEETING OF PARALEGALS

THE 5TH QUARTERLY MEETING OF PARALEGALS ON THE HUMAN RIGHTS EDUCATION AND PARALEGAL SCHEME PROJECT HELD ON THE 26TH OF JUNE 2020 AT UROMI JDPCI COMPLEX CHANCERY HALL, EGBELE, UROMI

INTRODUCTION

As part of the strategies for the implementation of the Human Right Education and Paralegal Scheme, Uromi Justice Development Peace and Caritas Initiative (Uromi JDPCI) conducted its 5th quarterly learning session with Paralegals of the Human Right Clubs across the 27 communities of the project intervention on the 26th of June 2020 at the Uromi JDPCI office complex (chancery hall). The session provided opportunity for Paralegals to discuss and dialogue human rights issues and challenges that may have arisen in their communities and what they did to resolve them. It also provided opportunity for the project team to assess the activities of the clubs as well as provide them with necessary technical support. A total of 63 participants amongst whom were 35 males and 28 females were present for the meeting. The

Paralegals took turns to give a presentation of activities so far carried out by their respective human rights clubs from the period April-June 2020

SUMMARY OF ACTIVITY

The meeting began by 10:00am prompt with the registration of participants after which opening prayer was led by one of the participants. This was followed by an opening Remark which was delivered by the Executive Director of Uromi JDPCI; Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis ARHEDO who used the opportunity to remind the paralegals that their selfless activities in promoting human rights and intervening in human rights violations would help to improve peaceful co-existence of the village community, promote social justice and respect for Human Right which was the goal of the Human Right Education and Paralegal Scheme intervention. He emphasized that such tasks were usually humanly unrewarded since they were services rendered in goodwill which could only be rewarded by God.

He enumerated cases of Human Right Violations currently been tackled by the Human Right Clubs and Uromi JDPCI in Esan Central, Esan West and Esan North East Local Government Areas and thus appreciated paralegals for their assiduous efforts in promoting human right activities in their communities and urged them to carry on tirelessly.



Executive Director taking response from paralegal

Immediately after that, the paralegals of the various Human Right Clubs made oral presentation of activities carried out within the quarter (April-June). These presentations were done according to local government areas with Esan Central taking the lead, followed by Esan West, Esan North East, Esan South East and Igueben.

ESAN CENTRAL LOCAL GOVERNMENT AREA

Ewu Community Human Right Club

The paralegal reported that, members successfully carried out their monthly meetings and issues concerning rape, the novel covid19 pandemic, freedom of opinion/expression and the importance of Human Right in the community were succinctly discussed. Also, he reported that the defilement case in her community which was already in Court was closely being monitored by the club members.

Usenu Community Human Right Club

The paralegal reported that monthly meetings and community sensitizations were carried out by the club members. General Human Rights and child abuse were discussed; this resulted to the report of a defilement case of a minor who was defiled by her father.



A Paralegal making report at the quarterly meeting

According to the paralegal, a further investigation

about the incident was carried out and it was discovered that the case was factual. However, the victim who happened to be the principal witness had already been taken away from the community by her family members to another State while the suspect absconded from the community. Therefore, a case could not be instituted before the police and the Court. The Human Right Club members thus, made an advocacy visit to the elders of the quarter in the community where the crime was perpetuated to sensitize them on Human Right and the activities of the Human Right Club and urged them to speedily report Human Right Violations to the club members for prompt intervention. Their efforts were commended while they were also encouraged to be more vigilant.

Agua Community Human Right Club

The paralegal of the Human Right Club of Agua Community reported that monthly meetings and community sensitizations were carried out by members of the club on child's right and harmful traditional practices. According to the paralegal, they engaged in household visitations during the sensitization in bid to adhere to the Federal Government's restriction on gatherings due to the covid19 pandemic. He explained that in one of such visit, a parent acknowledged the impact of the activities of the Human Right Club in the life of one of his children who begun to exhibit good attitudes after participating in the previous sensitization carried out by the Human Right Club members.



Another Paralegal giving report during quarterly meeting

Also the paralegal reported that a child made a complaint to the Human Right Club members about his inability to access online training done by his schools due to the covid19 pandemic. According to the child, he could not afford an android phone to enable him have access to these lessons thus approached his father who had an android phone but his request was denied and as a result, he was missing out greatly from learning activities in the school. The paralegal intervened by peacefully dialoguing and appealing to the father of the Child who heeded his request and the child now have access to online studies.

Akho Community Human Right Club

The paralegal reported that monthly meetings were carried out within the quarter, where issues concerning arrest/bail, freedom of expression and the rule of law were discussed. He also stated that sensitizations were carried out in small gathering in the community.

Idumebo Community Human Right Club

The paralegal reported the meetings held during the quarter wherein arrest/detention, child molestation and gender inequality were discussed and members after been educated on the subject, were now on a look out for violations while making personal contacts with persons in the community about human right activities.

ESAN WEST LOCAL GOVERNMENT AREA

Eguare-Ekpoma Community Human Right Club

According to the paralegal, monthly meetings were held within the quarter where issues concerning Inheritance, contact building and types/forms of Courts were discussed by members.

He reported a case of assault and battery melted on a young lady that resulted to bodily harm and due to their intervention, the matter was amicably resolved through the use of Alternative Dispute Resolution wherein the perpetrator of the assault made payment of her hospital bills and other damages caused to the victim.

Egoro-Amede Community Human Right Club

The paralegal reported that monthly meetings were held by the club members were issues on arrest/detention, conflicts and General Human Right matters were deliberated upon. She stated that within the quarter, Community Youth Sensitization on General Human Right was also



A paralegal presenting report during quarterly meeting

carried out by the Club members which has positively impacted the youth to be better law abiding citizens and promoters of peace. She also stated that the youths welcomed the message passed and indicated interest to become Human Right Club Members.

Ukpenu Community Human Right Club

At Ukpenu Community, the paralegal stated that monthly meetings were carried out within the quarter where issues on how to create better impacts through the activities of the human right club as well as burial rites were discussed. Members were encouraged to organize interpersonal sensitizations on human right matters.

Ukhun Community Human Right Club

The paralegal reported that meetings and community sensitizations were successfully carried out in the quarter. He stated that issues of Female Disinheritance, alternative dispute resolution and ways of reporting human right violations were matters discussed by members and subsequently sensitized community members on human rights. He relayed that a widow in the community reported how she had suffered from a breach of a contract involving the clearing of her farmland and the issue was peacefully resolved through the intervention of the human rights clubs via Alternative Dispute Resolution

Emaudo Community Human Right Club

According to the paralegal, the club members held their monthly meeting with the elders and youth members in the community and issues concerning Wills/Will making, next of kin, female disinheritance and gender inequality were talked about. He further stated that due to sensitizations, a



A Paralegal giving report at the quarterly meeting

long standing case of a female who was denied access to the properties of her late father was resolved amicably and as such, the female has been able to inherit the properties of her late father.

Also he stated that due to the transparency in the activities of the Human Right Club, members of the club were approached by the community to assist in distributing some palliatives provided by some sons and daughters of the Emaudo community to households

ESAN NORTH EAST LOCAL GOVERNMENT AREA

Ivwe Community Human Right Club

The paralegal reported that monthly meetings and community sensitizations were carried out on conflict resolution, female disinheritation, gender inequality and the rule of law. He said that the sensitizations carried out resulted in the resolution of females inheriting the properties of their parents. He further stated that in one of the sensitizations carried out in another quarter of the community, members asked for documentary evidence against female disinheritation and he reported that such document was not handy and as such, members of the Human Right Clubs resolved to make another visit to that quarter with the documents and policies against female disinheritation.

Erer Community Human Right Club

The paralegal reported that monthly meetings were successfully carried out in the quarter where the rule of Law/ equality and freedom of expression were discussed.

Amendokhian Community Human Right Club

The paralegal reported that child abuse, rape and indiscriminate use of security agents to recover loans or debts were discussed by members of the human right clubs during the monthly meetings held within the quarter. They were encouraged to report such indiscriminate use of law enforcement agencies to the appropriate authorities as such issues were basically civil as such not issues for them.

Efandion Community Human Right Club

The paralegal informed everyone present that monthly meetings were organized and carried out by the Human Right Club and unlawful arrest/detention, rape/child molestation and equity were topics discussed by members in the various meetings.

IGUEBEN LOCAL GOVERNMENT AREA

EGUARE IGUEBEN COMMUNITY HUMAN RIGHT CLUB

The paralegal reported that monthly meetings and Youth sensitizations were embarked upon by the Human Right Clubs wherein matters concerning Child Abuse as well as abilities to identify human right violations and prompt report of same were discussed and participants enjoyed the sensitization as they were deeply encouraged to set out boldly to kick against Human Right violations.



A cross section of participants during quarterly meeting

Idumeka Community Human Right Club

The paralegal reported that monthly meetings were carried out wherein participants discussed on the injustice and widow inheritance, Child right violations/child abandonment. Also within the quarter, members of the human right club conducted house to house sensitizations. These sensitizations were done by grouping each member of the club in threes, where six households were targeted by each group. Furthermore, he stated that a case of widow inheritance was reported to the human right club in which it was alleged that a young

man was banished from the community for refusal to inherit a widow. Members of the human right club investigated the case and realized that the information was not properly reported to them, because the young man was not denied access into the community instead he was approached by members of his family concerning his decision on not interested in inheriting the widow.

Amahor Community Human Right Club

The paralegal reported an incident which occurred in the community which has become a cause of concern to members of the Human Right Club on the unjust treatment of a victim of assault by the perpetrator of the assault and the community members. According to her, the suspect who was allegedly shot the victim of the assault in the cause of a heated misunderstanding was unjustly set free from police custody and was also supported by community members due to his influence as an occult and the victim is now been maltreated in the community. She explained that she is limited as to how to promote justice in that regard.

The Executive Director told the Supervisor of the LGA to investigate the matter since time does not run against crime.

Ebelle Community Human Right Club

The paralegal reported that monthly meetings and community sensitizations were done by the human right club members within the quarter. He said that during the sensitization, child rights, speech regulation and freedom of religion were discussed. Also, he reported that the sensitization yielded positive results as the elders acknowledged their effort geared toward fostering mutual love, respect and peaceful co-existence. He pointed to a question raised by one of the participants during the sensitization which was on the possibility of a parent restricting his offspring from some social gathering. To this Barr. ORIERE E.S, responded that the age of such offspring determines the level of influence such a parent could have on the child.

More so, the Paralegal reported a case of a Clergy (Pastor) in the community who impregnated a 16 years old Child and entreated a young boy who happened to be his Church member to accept responsibility for the pregnancy but the boy declined. He explained that the Girl's Parents confronted the Pastor concerning his deed and reported the issue to the police, adding that the matter has been charged to court.

Ewossa Community Human Right Club

The paralegal reported that monthly meetings were held within the quarter and that importance of child education and good citizenship were treated by members of the human right club extensively.

ESAN SOUTH EAST LOCAL GOVERNMENT AREA

Ahia Community Human Right Club

The paralegal reported that community sensitizations and monthly meetings were carried out within the reporting quarter. The sensitization was on female disinheritance. This he said was successfully carried out because of the positive response of the elders present during the sensitization wherein they accepted the message of allowing their female children to inherit their properties. While in the course of their monthly meeting, members discussed on arrest and harmful traditional practices.

He further stated that their farmers were ravaged by Fulani herdsmen, hence members of the human rights club wrote a letter to the Police which was signed by the community elders, requesting for assistance in addressing the herdsmen attack.

Emu Community Human Right Club

The paralegal reported that the human right club members held their monthly meetings within the reporting quarter and sensitized community elders, women and widows on ill-treatment of widows and female disinheritance. To this effect, the paralegal informed everyone that the elders promised to be on the watch against any form of gender based violence especially against women and promised to refer such findings to members of the human right club for appropriate actions.



A cross section of participants at the quarterly meeting

Ewatto Community Human Right Club

The paralegal reported that members of the human right club held their monthly meeting within the reporting quarter as well as sensitized their community on gender equality, female disinheritance and child abuse. According to the paralegals, members of the community were opened to the idea and however stated that disinheriting female children had been abolished by the community for a long time.

Ewohimi Community Human Right Club

The paralegal reported that monthly meetings were held by members of the club within the reporting quarter and also carried out sensitization on widowhood practices and female disinheritance wherein they admonished the elders to abolish cultural practices that subject Widows to all forms of maltreatment and to also afford women the right to have inheritance in their Father's house. He noted that the community elders accepted the message and promised to look into the issues raised.

The second Paralegal narrated that his Sister was asked to take an oath on the demise of her husband but through his intervention in which he confronted the elders that such practice was violation of human rights and was punishable by Law, his Sister was freed from taking the Oath.

The Program Manager appreciated him for the bold steps and admonished them to continually intervene in issues of human rights violation.

Okhuesan Community Human Right Club

The paralegal reported the meeting held by members of the Human Right Club in which gender inequality was discussed. He further explained that the Human Right Club also paid advocacy visit to the new Local Government Chairman and ceased the opportunity to report the negligence of the midwife in-charge of their community primary health center. The LGA Chairman promised to look into and he actually did by posting another midwife to the Primary Health Center.



Group photograph of participants at the quarterly meeting

Ubiaja Community Human Right Club

The paralegal reported the monthly meetings held within the quarter wherein land dispute and arrest were treated. He also reported a land dispute amicably resolved by the members of the human right club between the families of a deceased man who died interstate.

At the end of the reports, Uromi JDPCI commended the efforts of all the paralegals who on behalf of the respective Human Right Clubs presented their reports of activities done within the quarter. Special commendation was made to human rights clubs who made better impacts in their communities by sensitizing the people as well as intervening in violations of Human Right and resolving disputes amicably. He further advised them to spread their tentacles to persons living in extreme districts of the community especially the economically deprived members of the communities as they were most vulnerable to violation.

He however expressed great dissatisfaction to human right clubs, who were yet to create such impacts in their community, stating that their activities should not be limited to holding monthly meetings but should organize sensitizations, awareness campaigns as well as symposia on human rights issues so that community members would be equipped with the right information and thus be willing to report issues of violations.

TRAINING OF PARALEGALS AND HUMAN RIGHTS ADVOCATES ON GENDER EQUALITY AND GENDER BASED VIOLENCE HELD ON THE 15TH -19TH JUNE 2020 AT UROMI JDPCI COMPLEX (CHANCERY HALL)

Uromi Justice Development Peace and Caritas Initiative (Uromi JDPCI) conducted the Fourth training series for Paralegals and Advocates of the Human Rights Education and Paralegal Scheme project on the topic; “Gender Equality and Gender based Violence” with the objective of building the knowledge and capacity of Paralegals and Advocates on Gender Equality and Gender based Violence so as to enable them promulgate active participation of women in civil, cultural, economic, social and political life of their various communities as well as promote mass reorientation and enlightenment of communities members on issues of gender based violence and intervene when violations occurs or are premeditated. The training was held at Uromi JDPCI complex (chancery hall) from the 15th -17th of June 2020 and the presentations were facilitated by Barr ORIERE E.S (Supervisor; Esan West Local Government Area),



Very Rev Fr Dr Fidelis Arhedo giving the opening remark

Michael IYORIOBHE and Very Rev Fr. Dr. Fidelis ARHEDO. A total of 109 participants (56 male -and 53female) were in attendance at the training which was organized on Local Government basis so as to accommodate only 20 persons per session due to the global pandemic.

The Executive Director of Uromi JDPCI, Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo in his opening remark emphasized the importance of the activities of the Human Right Clubs in the various

communities. He stated that paralegal activities were humanitarian services geared towards bringing about sanity and wellbeing in the society.

He reminded the Paralegals and Advocates that they were voices to the voiceless and as such, needed to arm themselves with relevant information and knowledge to enable them address issues of human rights violations in their community,



A participant asking a question

He encouraged participants to be relentless in their efforts to make their community better inhabited as it was an act of good will that would be rewarded by God.

He concluded that with the right efforts and commitments, all the objectives and goals of the intervention would be achieved.

Thereafter, the training objectives were explained to the participants; which was aimed at building the knowledge and capacity of Paralegals and Advocates on Gender Equality and Gender based Violence so as to enable them promulgate active participation of women in civil, cultural, economic, social and political life of their various communities as well as promote mass reorientation and enlightenment of communities members on issues of gender based violence as well as intervene when violations occurs or are premeditated.

Thereafter, Facilitator Bar Oriere E.S began by explaining the concept of gender and sex, and defined gender as a socially constructed and learned economic, social and cultural attributes, characteristics and opportunities associated with being male or female. It involves the roles that men and women play, what is expected, allowed and valued in a woman or a man which vary widely among societies and can change over time.



Barr Oriere during his presentation

He then defined sex as biological makeup that defines males and females according to physical characteristics which are universal and fixed. Sex is a basic fact of nature which does not unfairly assign its biological roles but gender is imposed by human society which generates some deep and far reaching sense of inequality between the sexes. Adding that the roles that men and women play are influenced by the cultural and sometimes religious norms of the society, their social status in that society, other people's expectation and the image the individual wants to develop for himself or herself. Therefore, a person's role can change from time to time

depending on economic, social and cultural changes in the community. He further explained that in most societies, there were differences in activities undertaken by men and women, their access to and control over resources, as well as decision-making opportunities and these differences often times promote gender inequality.

Gender Inequality according to the facilitator gender inequality refers to the obvious or hidden disparity between individuals due to gender which mostly affects women more adversely than men. It is a social process by which people are treated differently and disadvantageously under similar circumstances on the basis of gender; placing a group; either male or female at an advantage over and above the other for no justifiable reason. It

was noted that gender inequality manifests itself differently according to race, culture, politics, country and economic situations. It acknowledges that men and women are not equal and that gender affects an individual's life experiences. An instance is the traditional Nigerian society, particularly Esanland where male children are preferred over the female child and are given names such as Omokhodion (A child is first) Omokhegbele (A child is the family) Omozokpia (The child makes a made) Omoike (A child is the backbone of the family) etc. Through these names, the male folks were made to believe that they were “superior” to the female children because only male children could bear these names and were frequently reminded of their roles differential. The female child/woman was considered inferior to the male child; her place in the society was considered to be in the kitchen and nowhere else, a situation that has created a huge gap of inequality between the male and the female child.



Another participant making asking a question

It was emphasized that gender inequality was against the dictates of **Section 42 of the 1999 Constitution of the Federal Republic of Nigeria.**



Group picture with some of the participants after the training

Besides being illegal, gender inequality has far reaching implications/effects on the female (victim) as well as the male and the society at large wherein Victims of gender discrimination often experience harassment which can lead to increased depression and anxiety on their part and such depression and anxiety do not only affect the victim but also extends to others around her whether in the home or at work. Also, it leads to increase in stress level of the victim, which can lead to greater chances of physical illness. Most often, discriminated individuals never reach the level needed for a high-status position or job in the society. Gender inequality kills the spirit of self-motivation and ingenuity in individuals because it makes people to see themselves to be of no relevance in a system.

It was stressed that a community that practices gender discrimination would sooner or later earn bad reputation for herself and the resultant effect is that; not many will be willing to have relationships with persons from such communities.

The Facilitator thus emphasized the equality of male and female in relation to gender and stated that gender inequality was an act against God's will. He admonished all to embrace gender equality by ensuring that children, whether male or female



Barr. Orere giving his presentation on gender based violence

are given equal opportunity to manifest their potentials and encouraged to choose careers of their choice. He stated that more women should be encouraged to participate in civil societal activities for the development of communities, elimination of gender stereotyping through structured participatory activities involving both sexes without discrimination, put in place wide range of laws to punish would be offenders and violators of persons' rights on the basis of gender inequality and increase the knowledge amongst the young that every man and woman is born with his/her own uniqueness.

The Third presentation was on **gender based violence, the types and causes**. Gender based violence was seen as any physical, mental or social abuse which is directed against a person on the basis of sex and has its roots in gender inequality. Gender based violence largely affects females in most societies; males are also victims/survivors but most gender discrimination occurs against females because they are disempowered in most societies when compared to their male counterparts.

Gender based violence include; domestic violence against women, battery, sexual harassment, manipulation within the home, the workplace or schools, sexual assault, exploitation and trafficking, rape, attempted rape, emotional abuse,



pornography, harmful traditional practices, Female Genital Mutilation/

Very Rev Fr., Dr., Fidelis Arhedo giving a presentation

female circumcision, child/forced marriage, dowry abuse, widow ceremonies, punishments directed at women for defying cultural norms, denial of education, food and clothing to girls/women by virtue of their sex and so on. It occurs as a result of Gender inequality, power imbalances between men and women, male attitudes of disrespect towards women including lack

of respect for the human rights of women and girls, unquestioned assumptions about appropriate male and female behavior, desire for power and control, political motives, including as a weapon of war, for power/control, traditional tensions, feuds, collapse of traditional society and family supports, cultural and traditional practices, religious beliefs etc.

It was noted that while both women and men experience violence, evidence suggested that the risk factors, patterns and consequences of violence against women were different from violence against men and it was argued that many cultures and beliefs, norms and social institutions legitimize and therefore perpetuate violence against women.

The Facilitator spoke on the physical emotional and psychological effects of gender based violence and advised all to work towards the elimination of gender based violence in the society, such that the interest, needs and priorities of both women and men are taken into consideration, recognizing the diversity of women and men.

Another presentation on harmful traditional practices that promote gender based violence was made. During which the Facilitator explained that the Nigerian Society was bedeviled with a number of harmful traditional practices which have adverse physical, emotional, cognitive and intellectual effect on the victim. He highlighted some of the harmful traditional practices to include:

- Preference for Unhygienic home delivery of babies to hospital delivery; where local traditional birth attendants who are mostly women take deliveries of children using unsterilized equipment and thus leads to unavoidable infections to the mother and possible harm on the new born baby.
- The practice of handling the care of a new born child over to an inadequately trained and unqualified housemaid (Child minders) who in most cases do not have prior experience in child care
- The practice of female circumcision otherwise known as Female Genital Mutilation often performed by elderly women who make use of crude, local and unsterilized implements. Caregivers have traditionally been taught by the society that it was right and proper to circumcise their female children hence many caregivers anticipate it with pride without considering the pain and harm it would cause to the child
- Widow inheritance – is a harmful traditional practice because of its method of implementation. In widow inheritance, the consent, feeling, status of the widow is largely not considered before she is handed over to a “new husband”. In some cases, the age differential between the widow and the man inheriting her are not even considered as



A participant responding to the question raised

it is believed that once a woman has been married into a family, she becomes ‘a property’ of that family for life..

- Child marriage which is the traditional practice of giving out a girl child in marriage at a tender age. This usually occurs at a time when the child do not know what marriage means.
- Widowhood rites: The Facilitator stressed that to a very large extent, the traditional Nigerian society has a belief that somebody somewhere must have a hand in the death of another person. This belief is so ridiculous that even when it was clear that a person had died as a result of extreme old age or protracted illness; it would still be attributed to somebody and in most cases, the wife of a man becomes the prime suspect when her husband dies and to prove her innocence, she would be subjected to so many rites which may include; drinking the water which was used in bathing the corpse of her husband, eating the food that was placed on her husband’s corpse, taking oath with her hands placed on her husband’s corpse, sleeping on worn-out mat on the floor and without bathing for 7 days, eating with her unwashed left hand for 7 days from unwashed plates, compulsory shaving of her hair, robbing of charcoal on her forehead for a period of 3 months and tying of certain substance (traditionally called IMHIN) round her wrists and ankles for a period of not less than 3 (three) months; believed to drive away the spirit of her dead husband. Meanwhile no man is ever made to go through these rites on the demise of their wife’
- Denial of property right such that females are not allowed to inherit the properties of their late parents; particularly landed properties. The reason for this was largely based on the belief that a woman who inherits her father’s estate will transfer such wealth to her husband’s family.



Michael Iyoriobhe during his presentation

Conclusively, the Facilitator stated that majority of these practices portrayed maltreatment against the female folks and the 1999 Constitution of the Federal Republic of Nigeria has outlawed discrimination on base on gender or anything whatsoever. Hence all should stand up to speak against these practices and enlighten elders and community members about the dangers as well as legal consequences of perpetuating such acts.

The second day of the training commenced with a brainstorming session in which participants were taken through a gender game involving practical demonstration to ascertain their understanding of gender based violence. Responses were elicited from participants on the following issues.

1. A lady who dresses indecently deserves to be raped.
2. A young man who dresses indecently deserves to be raped.

After critical brainstorming session it was observed that there have been incidents of minors, infants and even aged women being raped, not necessarily because they were indecently dressed. The participants then concluded that indecent dressing or any other reason was no excuse for raping a female or even a male.

3. A married woman or man caught in the act of adultery deserves to be packed out of the house.

On this issue, majority of the participants including the women responded that a married woman caught in the act of adultery deserves to be sent out of her matrimonial

home because it was an abomination in Esan tradition with adverse effect. They pointed that a man in Esan Culture cannot be said to have committed adultery because it was not a prohibited act, hence he does not deserve to be packed out of the house.

One of the Participants however opined that where a woman is sent out of the home, the man should be fined for the act committed.

To this, the facilitated noted that it was an unfair practice with uneven consequences that should be expunged.

The above was followed by a presentation on **Gender and Child Protection**. According to the facilitator, Child Protection speaks to the philosophies, policies, standards, guidelines, and procedures to protect children from both intentional and unintentional harm. It involves

the activities that are undertaken to protect specific children who are suffering, or are likely to suffer, significant harm.

He concluded by stating that the primary focus of child protection was child's safety; protecting children from maltreatment and ensuring that they grow up in circumstances consistent with the provision of safe and effective care.

The third day's activity started with a presentation on Emerging Issues in Gender and Sexual based violence. It was stressed that most women do not report cases of violence and the following reasons were attributed to it.

- Women fear that if they report the violence, it will continue to get worse.



Group photograph with participants during the first day of the training



Michael Iyoriobhe facilitating on emerging issues in gender and sexual based violence

- They fear they will lose economic support and be kicked out of the home.
- They fear that reporting the violence will bring shame and dishonor on the family.
- They fear that if they report, no one will listen.
- Women have been taught to stay silent – to protect family secrets at all costs.
- Women have accepted gender violence as a norm

The Facilitator encouraged participants to continually engage at community level in raising awareness for women to report issues of violations and mobilising men and women to advocate against the prevalence of gender and sexual based violence in communities.

The second presentation was on rape and emerging Issues. The Facilitator explained that in recent times, there have been increased incidences of rape in some of the focus communities, hence the need to enlighten Paralegals and Advocates on the topic so that they could have proper understanding of what rape meant and how to address it. Progressively, he defined rape as a type



Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo responding to issues raised by participants

of sexual assault usually involving sexual intercourse or other forms of sexual penetration perpetrated against a person without the person's consent.

Participants were taught steps to take in the event of rape. They include:

- A victim of rape must first proceed to a nearby Police Station to lodge a complaint. A victim must not change her dress, must not wash or shower after the incident and must not remove anything from the scene of crime because doing so may negatively affect pieces of evidence that the Police may need to hold the perpetrator accountable.
- Medical examination should be carried out as soon as possible, preferably on the day of the incident. Specifically within 72 hours to access post exposure prophylaxis to reduce the chances of HIV infection

Additionally they were taught the difference between rape and sexual assault. Sexual assault is any type of forced or coerced sexual contact or behaviour that happens without consent. Sexual assault includes rape and attempted rape, child molestation, and sexual harassment or threats, while rape involves a penetration of any other part of the body without the consent of the victim. In sexual assault, there need not be sexual intercourse (penetration) at all.

The Facilitator lamented the attitude of rape victims keeping silence after the crime and asked why it was the practice

The supervisor of Esan North East Local Government Area, explained that women choose to keep silent due to the following reasons; first, parental advice due to fear of social stigmatization perpetuated against the victim who are usually accused of seducing the criminal and as such the victim and members of her family are labelled uncultured and therefore not a family worthy to be married from, second was the high cost of ensuring justice which include; logistics paid by victim during extra judicial investigations, (police investigation) high cost of litigation and delay in the Justice system of Nigeria wherein rape issues are not included in accelerated hearing in Court.



Presentation by Very. Rev Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo

The participants concurred to the above statements and hoped that after the training, the human right club would ensure that the above hardships are mitigated through proper advocacy and sensitization activities in their various communities.

The last presentation was on gender analysis which was defined as the systematic examination of the roles, relations, opportunities, power and positions between men and women, boys and girls. It often involves the collection and use of quantitative and qualitative sex-disaggregated data which shows the different status, conditions, roles and responsibilities of women and men, girls and boys. He explained the Dimensions/Parameters for gender analysis which are: Access to Assets, Knowledge, Beliefs (Norms) & Perception, Practices, Roles and Participation, Legal Rights and Status and Power & Decision Making.

At the end of the session, Questions were asked by participants from various presentations for further clarification and answers were provided to clear all doubts.

ANTI HUMAN TRAFFICKING DESK

DON'T PAY WITH YOUR LIFE

THE DISBURSEMENT OF FUND TO THE BENEFICIARIES OF “DON'T PAY WITH YOUR LIFE PROJECT HELD ON THE 9TH AND 10TH OF JUNE 2020 AT THE CHANCERY COMPLEX, EGBELE-UROMI.

Uromi JDPCI organized a ceremony on the occasion of the disbursement of funds to the beneficiaries of the “Don't Pay with your life” project. The ceremony was spread over two days (9th and 10th of June, 2020) due to the Nigerian Government restriction on the number of people to be gathered in an instance as a result of the global pandemic. A total of 43(for the two days) beneficiaries/caregivers got monetary support for



Cross section of beneficiaries during the opening prayer

income generating activities to the tune of one hundred thousand naira each, being the first installment of the project grant. This was to enable them engage in income generating activities and be able to take care of the educational needs of their children. By so doing the children could be retained in school as such, assuage their livelihood situations and vulnerability to human trafficking. Present at the ceremony were; the Executive Director of Uromi JDPCI; Very. Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis ARHEDO, Staff of Uromi JDPCI and representative of Girls Power initiative (GPI), Mrs. Ruthmary OBASANMI, the program Coordinator; Michael Iyoriobhe and other project staff



The program manager welcoming caregivers to the ceremony

In the opening remark, the Executive Director of Uromi JDPCI; Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis ARHEDO, expressed great delight in welcoming the beneficiaries to the occasion. He stated that the intervention -“Don’t Pay with your life” was targeted at blocking the influx of young girls on the road to Europe, Asia and other parts of the world through the desert and the Mediterranean Sea which is very risky. He noted that it was discovered from

findings carried out, that most children involved in this risky venture were from poor and vulnerable homes, whose parents had failed in their responsibilities in taking care of their children, he however pointed out that it might not have been the fault of some parents in this category, due to the lack of economic means to handle obligations. Youths who risk their lives to Europe in a bid to make it in life would have preferred to remain in Nigeria if only they had someone to support them in the education domain and other business domains in life.

He pointed out that the “Don’t Pay with your life”



project is in a way, a continuation of the PACKING intervention which started in 2017 through 2018 in reaching



out to vulnerable households in a bid to checkmate the prevalence of human trafficking in Edo State.

In reaching out with the “Don’t Pay with your life “intervention, he explained that Uromi JDPCI partnered with ECPAT and GPI to stamp out trafficking in Edo State, wherein over a hundred

vulnerable households were assessed across the five Local government areas of Edo Central Senatorial District and 50 of them emerged successful based on their degree of vulnerability. He further explained that on this occasion, the first batch of beneficiaries made up of 43 caregivers of 43 children/wards from vulnerable homes would be empowered with the sum of one hundred thousand naira (#100,000) as take up grant and will later receive the second and final disbursement which is fifty thousand naira (#50,000), making the total grant, one hundred and fifty thousand naira (#150,000) with which they would start up businesses and care for the school needs of these children. He added that the 43 children would also be given one year educational scholarship package to the tune of fifty thousand naira(#50,000). The empowerment, he said was a social enterprise which would eventually take the beneficiaries from the level of vulnerability to human trafficking and prostitution to income generating activities with measurable social impacts. He noted that these activities were geared towards finding lasting solution to the issue of poverty which makes them vulnerable to traffickers and other vices.

He admonished the caregivers to encourage their children to focus on their education, get a degree or other tertiary degree or advance functional skills that will prepare them for the future.

In conclusion, he thanked ECPACT for partnering with Uromi JDPCI and appreciated Girls Power Initiative for considering Uromi JDPCI at the initial stage to be a part

of the process.

In her goodwill message Girls Power Initiatives represented by Ruthmary OBASANMI; advised beneficiaries to utilize the money to be disbursed to them judiciously so as to make profits for the training of the girl child.

After the goodwill massage, a grant award of one hundred thousand naira (#100, 000) was presented to each of the caregivers.



Good will message by Ruthmary Obasanmi; GPI representative



A beneficiary appreciating and praying for ECPAT and Uromi JDPCI

The caregivers beaming with joy rendered praises and prayers of Blessing to ECPAT France, ECPAT Luxembomg and Uromi JDPCI for the



A caregiver receiving the grant award

empowerment. They stated that the business training received from Uromi JDPCI to become business models for the purpose of retaining their children in school as well as the grant to carry out their business plan was a huge relief to them. They promised to be diligent, innovative and employ strategies learnt in business venture so as to gain the needed economic power to see their children through school as well as providing for their needs. They rejoiced and danced as many of them received credit alerts on their mobile phones even before the end of the ceremony and indeed attested that ECPAT and Uromi JDPCI kept to their word.

Conclusion: The activity ended successfully with the caregivers ready to start their respective businesses with the grant received and as such, empowered to carry out their parental responsibilities towards their children.



FOCUS GROUP DISCUSSION WITH THE BENEFICIARIES OF “DON’T PAY WITH YOUR LIFE” AND “PACKING” PROJECTS HELD ON THE 8TH, 11TH AND 12TH OF JUNE 2020.

Uromi JDPCI conducted the second session of the focus group discussion with the caregivers of the beneficiaries of the Don’t Pay with Your Life project and the caregivers who were empowered under the PACKING project across the five Local Government Areas of the project intervention in Edo Central Senatorial District. The subject of discussion during the meeting was “Understanding children’s Personality”. The caregivers were thus taken through the following topics: The meaning of Personality? The basic types of child personalities, How Parents should respond to their children based on their personality type, children’s stages of development and how to meet their needs differently depending on the developmental stage and how to address the needs of children with disabilities. The sessions were very participatory and involved role play and brainstorming with Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo, Michael Iyoriobhe and Erhabor Harriet as the facilitators. The focus group discussion was held across the five Local Government Areas between 8th and 12th of June, 2020

A total of 85 caregivers across the five Local Government Areas attended the focus group discussion with 4 project staff.



In the different Local Government Areas, the discussion started with an opening prayer which was followed closely with introductory remark by the Program Manager; Iyoriobhe



Michael who welcomed the caregivers and thanked them for making out time to attend the meeting. He explained the importance of the focus group discussion which includes educating caregivers on how to be better role model and influence to their wards in order to build up a better society.

An interactive recap of the previous discussion on “Parenting Responsibility” was done and feedback were elicited from the caregivers wherein some of them shared how they have improved on their parenting style towards their wards, showing them love and care and being fair in dealing with them rather than being hostile, scary or uninvolved in their daily lives and as such bringing about progressive changes in their children attitudes.

Following immediately was the presentation of the topic; understanding children’s personality. It was emphasized by the facilitators that understanding children’s personality traits helps parents to understand why their children acts the way they do, thus guiding them to strengthen their weaknesses and harness their strengths. Personality was



defined as a make- up of emotional qualities, thoughts and behaviors that make a person different from other people. It was stressed that these personality differences in children



make them distinct from each other. It was further stated that if a child’s personality is well understood by parents, it will be well managed and the result would be molding children with attractive qualities. However if it is not well managed the reverse would be the case and this can lead to children running away from the house or engaging in irregular migration just to avoid the parents/caregivers.

The Five basic types of Children's Personalities were enumerated to include: Active/Inattentive Child, the Angry/Impulsive Child, the Rebellious/Independent Child; the Sensitive/Shy Child and the Inactive/Dreamy Child.



The Facilitators explicitly explained the qualities noticeable in the five personalities of children and how parents and caregivers can effectively respond



to their children. Accordingly, the Active/Inattentive Child was said to be very interested in doing and exploring things, likes to be physically active, does not stay still, has a short attention span and may forget things as well as lacking the ability to hold a long conversation with persons. For better parenting response for a child with this personality trait, they caregivers were admonished to: Complement the child when he or she does well, not focusing on the child's lack of attention, advising the child to think better about his/her behavior, assisting the child to do one thing at a time and helping the child spend a little bit longer at each task in a gradual manner.

The Angry/Impulsive Child has difficulty in controlling emotions, feels unfairly treated, gets upset easily, uses physical force in getting what he / she wants, does things without thinking and often labeled as trouble makers. In handling such children, Caregivers were advised to be patient with them but set clear limits, be warm, nurturing and trusting, compliment the child when he/she does things right, try to understand reasons behind his /her attitude, assist the child to express his / her feelings through words and teach the child to think about his /her behavior and slowly gain more control.

Whereas the Rebellious/ Independent child manifest the following behaviors: Do not like been told what to do, stubborn and willful, often take leadership role but may be negative and controlling and sometimes does opposite of what is expected. For children with this personality trait, Caregivers were urged to be patient with them but set clear limits, gentle and respectful, compliment the child when he/she does well, try to understand the reasons behind his /her attitudes, give the child expected and positive choices to choose from and support the child in making more flexible changes that would make him/her more cooperative.

For the Sensitive or Shy Child, It was explained that such children usually feels strong emotions, act fearful of other people, do not easily trust others, shy in making friends and does not like changes and new situations. Caregivers were advised to be patient and take things slowly with a child with such personality trait, be very gentle but firm, complement the child when he/she does well, try to understand reasons behind his / her attitude and often accompany the child to explore

new experiences. Finally, the Inactive/Dreamy Child are quiet and not always aware of things happening around them, they prefer own thoughts and fantasizes on the outside world, easily get tired and are not interested in exploring new things. On this, the Facilitators advised parents of such children to be patient but firm, complement the child when he/she does well, try to understand if there is a good reason behind his/her attitude including physical illness or malnutrition and respond appropriately, make special efforts to attract the child's interest, and suggest activities that do not take a lot of physical energy.

The Caregivers were told that children will not always fit into one personality type. Thus they may display behaviors that fall under different types at different times, however one of the traits will be more prominent. Furthermore, it was stated that some parts of a child's personality can change as he or she grows older but other parts are inborn and may not change hence they need to be understood and well managed as it is easier to raise children when their personalities are known.

The next presentation was on the factors that influence a child's personality. These factors were given to include: heredity, environment, birth order, gender and age.

Heredity was explained as genes that parents pass down to their children, while environment are places children spend time which includes home, school and neighborhood. Birth order was referred to as the different ways parents treat their children from the oldest to the youngest and gender talks about the different behaviors expected from girls or boys and finally age influences behavior of children in accordance to their needs. Participants were made to understand that the family and home environment are the greatest influences on a child's personality. Hence, Parents and Caregivers are to provide their children with the most positive home environment possible.

Thereafter, the Facilitators taught the caregivers the different stages of child development- infancy which is between age 0-1, toddler within ages 2-3, early childhood within ages 4-5, middle childhood within ages 6-12 and late childhood/adolescent within ages 13-17. It was pointed out that children in each of these stages of development have different needs ranging from Physical, intellectual, social and emotional needs and they express these needs through their behaviors. The primary needs of infants are quest for food, sleep, cleaning, comfort, safety, strong attachment with parents/caregivers stimulation and attention and they express this through smiles and cries. At this stage, caregivers ought to provide support, care and protection by cuddling, and caressing the child.

As for toddlers, they become more curious, want to explore and become more independent; can begin to learn how to manage emotions. The facilitators advised caregivers to render praises to their children at this stage whenever they do new things, distract the child from bad behaviors and not physically punish.

During early childhood, children start to develop relationship with other children, they do not know how to differentiate fantasies from realities may talk a lot and does not like to lose or share turns. Caregivers were advised to help children solve their problems.

At middle childhood, children become more interested in school activities, want more independence, want to spend more time with other children, express interest in religious matters, become self-conscious and sensitive and might be very active. Parents were advised to spend more time with their children and share experiences with them.

Finally, during late childhood/adolescence, children seek more independence, loves attention and acceptance from peers for self-esteem, focus on forming their identity, becomes challenging and rebellious, experience frequent mood swings, becomes interested in sexual issues, worry about the future etc. At this stage the Caregivers were advised to be very patient, wise, attentive and supportive.

The facilitators also enlightened the caregivers on the need to understand and care for children with disabilities that is children who are physically challenged such as children with difficulties in hearing, visually impaired, handicapped etc. They were told that such children need adequate care, attention and love and aided to overcome barriers that prevent them from being involved with normal activities such as school or community life as well as relating with peers.

The caregivers were filled with appreciations for the knowledge passed to them and testified that they have learnt enough to help become better and influential parents. However, the following concerns were raised by some of the caregivers in the respective Local Government Areas and the issues were adequately addressed by the Facilitators while the caregivers expressed satisfaction with the answers given.

MONITORING VISIT TO BENEFICIARIES OF LIVELIHOOD SUPPORT (PACKING AND DPWYL PROJECT)

Uromi Justice Development Peace and Caritas Initiatives in a bid to sustain the impact of the livelihood support on beneficiaries of the PACKING project provided routine monitoring to ascertain their level of improvement in business and education, determine their challenges and provide technical support where necessary. Uromi JDPCI project team visited a total fifty (50) beneficiaries across communities in five Local Government Areas. 45 out of the 50 beneficiaries representing 90% were observed to still be in business or have the potentials to return to business after the COVID19 and also have their children in school while five were out of business and four of them said that their reasons was due to ill health. It was also gathered during the monitoring visit that three out of the five beneficiaries who were no longer in business have completed their secondary education but due to economic hardship they were not able to further their education. Two of the beneficiaries took to vocational skill acquisition as an alternative. Regrettably the project team was informed that one of the beneficiaries got married outside the community after she completed her secondary education but the mother and the other siblings

were still surviving on the business established



A beneficiary in her Crey fish shop

with the support of the project. The team also visited the mother of Christabel who died in a pond



A beneficiary in her hair dressing shop

trying to get water, she was met at home with her other children, she said she has tried to move on so that she can care for the remaining children. She again expressed her sincere appreciation to the project for the support given to her which has sustained them through difficult times. She said she will continue to train the other children with the proceeds of the business and appeal to the project team not to stop coming to check on her as the teams' presence was a huge relief and motivation for her.

Most of the beneficiaries were met at their homes during the visit due to the COVID19 pandemic that led to the imposition of a lot of restriction and on movement and business. Only those who sell food items were seen in their shop, as others whose businesses were categorized as non-essential were not allowed to open their shop. Although most of them complained about economic hardship due to the lockdown imposed by the government at all levels, they were encouraged to be caution of the life after the pandemic which could be worse if they do not discipline themselves and guide their business fund/investment jealously.



Bags of Kolanuts being shown to the monitoring team

The beneficiaries all expressed their appreciation and thanked the project team and sponsors for the kind gesture extended to them, noting that the livelihood support has alleviated their economic plight in no small measure until the Global pandemic set in. They said that the pandemic has affected them adversely as many of the were at home feeding on their resources for their business and not sure whether they will have resource to return to business after the COVID 19 was over. Some of them appealed for a little more



A beneficiaries showing her Akpu preparation process

support to return them to business after the global pandemic. These beneficiaries were

placed on a continuous monitoring by the DPWYL Program, operated by ECPAT, France, ECPAT Luxembourg and Uromi JDPCI with support from AFD, Ministry of Foreign and European Affairs of Luxembourg to ensure effective use of the grant given to them for the overall benefit of their households.

SUSTAINABLE MEASURE AGAINST TRAFFICKING IN PERSONS (SMAT-P)

Monitoring Visit

Following the schedule by the Organization to visit the



caregivers whose capacity were built on their chosen businesses in order to maximize profit so as to alleviate the livelihood plights of the beneficiaries which hitherto made them



susceptible to human trafficking and irregular migration, Uromi JDPCI monitored 95 beneficiaries in Esan Central and Esan South East Local Government Areas to ascertain the current status of their businesses and assess its impact in their household. It was discovered that 40 out of the 50 beneficiaries visited in Esan Central were still in business and had experienced



significant improvement in their businesses and families while 10 were out of business due to the COVID 19 restrictions and other factors. Whereas in Esan South East, out of the 45



beneficiaries visited, 35 were still in business while 3 were out of business- 2 travelled and the other could not conduct business activity as a result of the COVID 19 lockdown. More so, 22 vocational skills beneficiaries were visited in the two Local Government Areas of the project intervention- 14 in Esan Central and 8 in Esan South East.

MICRO CREDIT

Empowerment of the less privileged in the society has always been one of the major policy thrust of Uromi JDPCI. For this reason the Micro credit scheme was established to provide soft loans for enterprise development. These soft loans are given to groups as well as registered cooperative societies who are into active economic activities. Each group consists of poor,



PROMIC Officers and members of Peace Farmers Association during formation and training at Amendokhian, Uromi

active women and active farmers in the society. This scheme is open to Catholics and Non-Catholics within the Diocese of Uromi. The scheme is currently supporting a total of 1110 persons in all the five Local Government Areas covered by the Catholic Diocese of Uromi.

The scheme is in four (4) platforms namely: Group Micro-Credit, PROMIC I, PROMIC II and AGRIC PROMIC (for farmers only). It is a basic requirement that beneficiaries form themselves into self-selected group before they are considered for assessment and training. Upon successful registration, validation and documentations, the members of the group then qualify to get soft loan which must be disbursed to them through their bank accounts.

The Agricultural scheme was introduced to enhance the production and livelihood opportunity of



PROMIC Officers and beneficiaries of Progress Group during collection at Ubiaja

the farmers.

The scheme is designed to address the plight of the rural farmers to help increase their agricultural



Monitoring visit to micro credit beneficiary's store

productivity and also for active farmers who

wish to move from subsistence farming to small scale commercial farming.

In this quarter a total of 6 groups with 53 members were supported to improve their businesses including farming business across communities in Edo Central Senatorial District. Monitoring visits to the various groups showed that the beneficiaries have gainfully invested their soft loans in their businesses and farms in line with the objectives of the scheme. Uromi JDPCI appreciated the various groups for their solidarity and urged them to co-operate with the organization and show more commitment to repayment that could possibly qualify them for another round of loan. The various groups led by their group leaders thanked Uromi JDPCI for their support and promised to improve on their members' commitment, and pleaded for increase of the soft loan as things were becoming very expensive.